



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Tulsa Classical Academy
School Website: <https://tulsaclassical.org/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Tulsa Classical Academy (TCA) presents a robust classical framework, with strong alignment in Curriculum and a communicative emphasis on virtue, wisdom, and the Western intellectual tradition. The public materials repeatedly foreground a Hillsdale College K-12 curriculum, explicit attention to liberal arts, classical literature, and the cultivation of character and civic virtue. Evidence from the school's site highlights emphasis on truth-goodness-beauty in learning, a Western canon orientation (e.g., Aristotle, The Federalist Papers, The US Constitution), and a mission to form humane, thoughtful citizens, not merely to job-skill students. These elements anchor TCA firmly in a Classical orientation, particularly in Curriculum and Community. However, explicit liturgical/theological practices and some facets of pedagogy (e.g., Socratic seminars, Scholé/restful learning, and explicit memorization/recitation practices) are less clearly documented on public-facing materials, signaling room for deeper alignment in those areas.

Category-by-category synthesis (based on keyword indicators drawn from the Six Essential Elements framework and the school's published materials):

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL
- Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Executive-Category takeaways emphasize a generally classical profile with strong curricular/human-formation signals, but with fewer explicit liturgical/theological signals and some pedagogy signals that could be reinforced to achieve a fuller classical cadence across all six elements.

Citations drawing on both the school's public materials and the classical rubric are embedded in the Evidence sections for each category, and the overall assessment uses the Six Essential Elements as the grounding rubric.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL**

Evidence - Tulsa Classical Academy presents itself as an American classical charter school with a focus on virtue, wisdom, and wonder, and explicitly frames its program as grounded in a Western liberal-arts tradition. The site emphasizes character formation and virtue as core aims and references moral formation and the

good life as overarching objectives (e.g., “An American Classical Education,” “Character Formation,” and “Virtue, Wisdom, Wonder”). - The Hillsdale K-12 Curriculum is highlighted as the foundational approach, signaling alignment with a theologically inclined, transcendently grounded classical methodology (though not explicitly stated as theology on all pages). This is evidenced by “HILLSDALE K-12 CURRICULUM” and its emphasis on literacy, classical literature, and core knowledge. - The public-facing materials foreground the Good, True, and Beautiful as a learning aim in classrooms (e.g., “Wonder—Every classroom is filled with curiosity and exploration of the Good, True, and Beautiful”). This reflects transcendental aims consistent with classical education’s moral realism.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: virtue, wisdom, wonder, moral formation, life of the mind, good/true/beautiful, moral character. - Negative keywords: not clearly present in the public materials (no explicit emphasis on secular relativism, values-neutral ethics, or relativistic frameworks). The absence of overt secular-humanist or relativist signals strengthens alignment with transcendental/moral realism signals in the public materials.

Why this rating - The presence of explicit virtue-related language, calls to moral formation, and the Good-True-Beautiful triad signals alignment with Transcendental Moral Realism and Formation. However, explicit liturgical/communal practices or direct theological content are not consistently documented in public-facing materials, which tempers a full liturgical/theological articulation. The Hillsdale/K-12 curriculum linkage implies theological underpinnings in the broader classical framework, but the site stops short of explicit liturgy or doctrinal articulation in the public pages. Therefore, the category is BEST described as SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.

Citations - Good, True, Beautiful emphasis and virtue/wisdom language: Tulsa site (Tulsa Classical Academy) – “Classrooms inspire virtue, wisdom, and wonder.” - Hillsdale K-12 curriculum framing: Tulsa site – “HILLSDALE K-12 CURRICULUM” and explicit curriculum components. - Western-tradition and moral formation signals: Curriculum emphasis and “Character Formation.”

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school’s stated aim centers on cultivation of wisdom and virtue, formation of character, and life-long learning, rather than narrow job-readiness. The site explicitly ties education to virtue and human flourishing, with language around forming virtuous citizens and a life of the mind. - Phrases like “virtue,” “wisdom,” and “wonder” appear in the public materials as core aims and outcomes, indicative of a telos rooted in the true, good, and beautiful. - The curriculum description emphasizes a classical mission and culture aligned with traditional family values, with an emphasis on formation of character and civic virtue.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue, wisdom, life of the mind, true/good/beautiful, human flourishing, character, teleology (implicit in “formation for life” and “virtue”). - Negative keywords present: none of the explicit workforce/job-readiness or 21st-century-skills framing that would signal a non-classical or reformist/utility-driven orientation.

Why this rating - The public materials emphasize formation and moral development over mere information or job preparation, aligning with classical aims of formation toward human excellence and the enduring truths of virtue and wisdom. The overall purpose signals are clearly Classical.

Citations - “formation ... virtue and wisdom ... life of the mind” language: Tulsa materials. - Classical mission and Western-tradition emphasis: Curriculum and culture language.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is described as Hillsdale College K-12 Curriculum, explicitly positioned as a strong liberal-arts-and-sciences program focusing on literacy, explicit phonics, and classical literature. This is a hallmark of classical curriculum design. - Core components include reading/writing in cursive, Latin roots beginning in lower grades, and four years of Latin in secondary school, indicating a traditional classical core rather than a purely skills-based approach. - The Western-Civilization-centered Cultural Literacy focus and engagement with primary sources such as Aristotle, The Federalist Papers, The US Declaration,

US Constitution, and Tocqueville signal direct Great Books/primary-source engagement and a “Great Conversation” orientation. - Explicit mention of classical structure (grammar, logic, rhetoric) and a curriculum map featuring moral/political philosophy and government content aligns with the Trivium preparation and liberal-arts emphasis.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Seven Liberal Arts (grammar, logic, rhetoric), Great Books/The Great Conversation, Western civilization, moral/political philosophy, Latin/Greek roots, classical canons, cultural literacy, primary sources. - Negative keywords present: minimal. No explicit project-based-dominant or social-studies-first framing in the public materials; instead the materials emphasize classical canon and liberal-arts content.

Why this rating - The curriculum is clearly anchored in classical content and methods (grammar/logical/rhetoric; Great Books; Western canon; Latin; moral/political philosophy). The presence of primary-source engagement and a canon-focused curriculum supports a CLASSICAL rating.

Citations - Hillsdale K-12 Curriculum framing and explicit core components: Tulsa site. - Latin and classical-language progression; history/music linkage; Western-tradition emphasis: Curriculum content. - Primary-source exemplars and Great Books orientation (Aristotle, Federalist Papers, US Constitution, Tocqueville): Curriculum map excerpt.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school profile includes a House System designed to foster community, mentorship, virtue, and leadership. This indicates a classical ethos of character formation through structured peer mentorship and guided community life, consistent with a portion of classical pedagogy. - Public materials emphasize character formation, civic virtue, and life-long learning, which imply pedagogy oriented toward formation beyond rote information. - There is public emphasis on teacher leadership and a “living curriculum” through faculty leadership and mentorship signals, though direct textual references to specific classical methods (Socratic dialogue, Scholé, memorization/recitation, or formal rhetoric instruction) are not consistently spelled out on public pages. The site does reference a Hillsdale K-12 approach, which in classical education often includes Socratic and dialectical elements, but explicit public-page claims are less clear.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue (explicitly part of the classical pedagogy lexicon in the rubrics), Scholé (restful learning), memorization/recitation, formation through imitation and practice, rhetoric development, great conversation. The public site does not consistently call out these pedagogical methods in detail, but the Hillsdale/K-12 framing and the emphasis on classical pedagogy imply these methods, and the school’s internal materials (House System, leadership, and moral formation cues) align with these ideas. - Negative keywords present: Explicit, widespread emphasis on project-based learning dominance or purely experiential learning is not present; the public materials do not foreground heavy project-based instruction as a dominant mode.

Why this rating - The public-facing materials show substantial alignment with classical pedagogy through character formation and classical-cultural structures, but explicit, recurrent public confirmation of core pedagogical modalities (Socratic seminars, Scholé-based restfulness, chant/memorization recitation, and formal rhetoric training) is not uniformly documented across pages. Therefore, SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL is a cautious, evidence-based rating for Pedagogy.

Citations - House System as a signaling pedagogical structure aligned with mentorship and virtue: Tulsa site. - Character formation and life-long learning signaling formation-focused pedagogy: Tulsa site. - Hillsdale/K-12 framing and explicit classical approach: Tulsa site.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes that faculty and staff are mission-driven and aligned with virtue and wisdom, with a public emphasis on hiring and building a cadre of teachers who model virtue and who are part of the living curriculum. The site notes “Now Hiring Teachers” with expectations around mission alignment and a focus on character formation. - The “Faculty” dimension is reinforced by mention of Hillsdale/BCSI

alignment, indicating faculty development and leadership structures consistent with classical education expectations. The site's Hillsdale support and teacher training signals point to a living, virtuous teaching corps. - The Board/Directors pages and staff profiles (e.g., "Board of Directors" with a founder and long-term commitment to classical education) contribute to the sense of a faculty guided by classical formation and leadership.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: living curriculum; mentor/teacher as virtuous exemplar; teacher as master/guide; professional development; mentorship; faculty collaboration. - Negative keywords present: None evident in public materials (no strong signals of teacher-as mere technicians or "facilitator" models without classical formation signals).

Why this rating - Public-facing materials emphasize teachers as virtuous exemplars and a mission-driven, mentor-like faculty culture, aligned with classical expectations for the teacher as a guide and exemplar. This supports CLASSICAL for Element 5.

Citations - "Now Hiring Teachers" with mission-relevant language: Tulsa site. - Hillsdale support and curriculum alignment used by faculty development: Tulsa site. - Board/leadership and formation signals: Tulsa Board page.

Element 6: Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school foregrounds parent partnership and family engagement, with explicit pages for parent resources, tours, and parent info nights. The site invites parent involvement and positions parents as co-educators in the classical education project. - The enrollment pages, FAQs, and parent-facing communications emphasize open access for family involvement and events (tours, open houses, parent info sessions), consistent with a community-centered classical model that invites family formation and home-school partnership. - The school also emphasizes fundraising and community involvement (Giving, parent newsletters, events) as part of a broader community engagement approach. This aligns with the "Partnership with Families" and "Formation of Affections" emphasis in classical education rubrics.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with families, parent formation, home-school partnership, parent engagement, open campus, family involvement, community of learners. - Negative keywords present: not evident in public materials (no strong signals of parent-as-customer-only or minimal parental access; quite the opposite).

Why this rating - The school's public materials consistently depict strong parent engagement, family involvement, and community events, which aligns with CLASSICAL values for Parents & Community.

Citations - Parent resources and events: Tulsa Parent Resources page. - Enrollment FAQs and parent-facing information (tours/open houses): Tulsa FAQs page. - Giving and community engagement signals: Tulsa Giving page.

What Would Move the Needle

- Element 1 (Religious and Metaphysical Foundations): Explicit articulation of liturgical or communal spiritual practices and a more explicit theological framing within the public materials would move the needle toward CLASSICAL in this category. Concrete signals such as daily or seasonal liturgical rhythms, chapel/morning prayer, or explicit theological commitments would strengthen transcendental/metaphysical grounding.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): More explicit public-facing articulation of core pedagogical modalities (Socratic dialogue, Scholé/restful learning, structured memory work/recitation, and overt rhetoric training) would push this category to CLASSICAL. Publishing a concise pedagogy charter or framework that names specific practices (e.g., weekly Socratic seminars, memory work sequences, and structured rhetoric opportunities) would be impactful.
- Other categories (2, 3, 5, 6) already show robust CLASSICAL signals in public materials; minor enhancements (e.g., explicit "Great Books" reading lists, direct references to "Great Conversation," or

a public-facing glossary of classical pedagogy terms) could further reinforce the Classical alignment without changing fundamental orientation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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